

**1 October 1949**

PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF CHINA IS ESTABLISHED

In the four years after World War II, the long-running conflict between Nationalists and Communists for control of China swung in favour of Mao Zedong's Communists. From late 1948, the Nationalist leader Chiang Kai-shek started withdrawing his forces to the island of Taiwan, ceding control of the mainland. Following several decisive victories, including the capture of the Nationalist capital Nanjing, Mao officially proclaimed the establishment of the People's Republic in Beijing's Tiananmen Square.

◁ Propaganda poster featuring Mao Zedong



1893-1976
MAO ZEDONG

A Marxist-Leninist, Mao helped found the Red Army and became head of the Communist Party, leading the struggle against the Nationalists for control of China. After proclaiming the People's Republic of China, he was the nation's leader until his death.

1 September 1951 Australia, New Zealand, and the US
sign the ANZUS Pacific Security Treaty

8 September 1951 The Allied military occupation of Japan ends when a treaty signed in San Francisco hands back sovereignty

4 November 1952 Dwight D. Eisenhower is elected 34th President of the US

1952

**18 April 1951**

TREATY OF PARIS

Scarred by the horrors of war, leaders from France, Germany, Italy, and the Benelux countries determined to co-operate on a supranational level. A treaty, championed by the French diplomat Jean Monnet, set up the European Coal and Steel Community, which in time would evolve into first the European Economic Community (EEC) and later the European Union (EU).

◁ European Coal and Steel Community poster

▽ Rebel suspects under guard

**3 October 1952**

MAU MAU REBELLION

Amid resentment at British rule in Kenya, militants of the clandestine Kenya Land and Freedom Army – also known as the Mau Mau – launched an uprising against white settlers and the colonial authorities. The revolt was put down with great brutality, but the drive for majority rule continued and, in December 1963, Kenya became an independent nation.

“There is no future for the people of Europe other than in union.”

JEAN MONNET, 1950